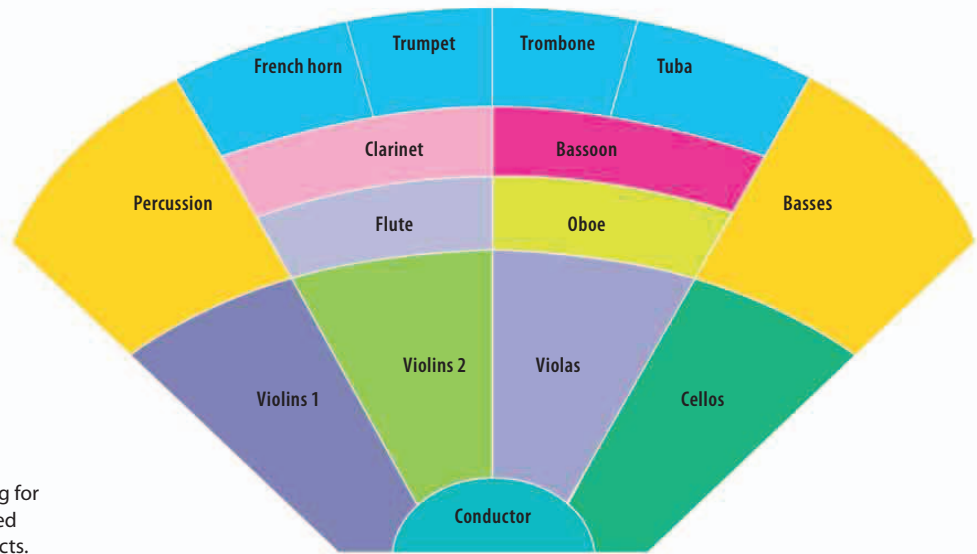


Orchestral music

Music written for an orchestra is the heart of classical repertoire, and most major composers have made their mark with their orchestral works. Symphonies by Haydn, Mozart, Beethoven, Schubert, Brahms, Tchaikovsky, Mahler, and Shostakovich; tone poems by Richard Strauss, Ravel, and Debussy; and concertos by Mendelssohn and Bruch are favorites with audiences worldwide.

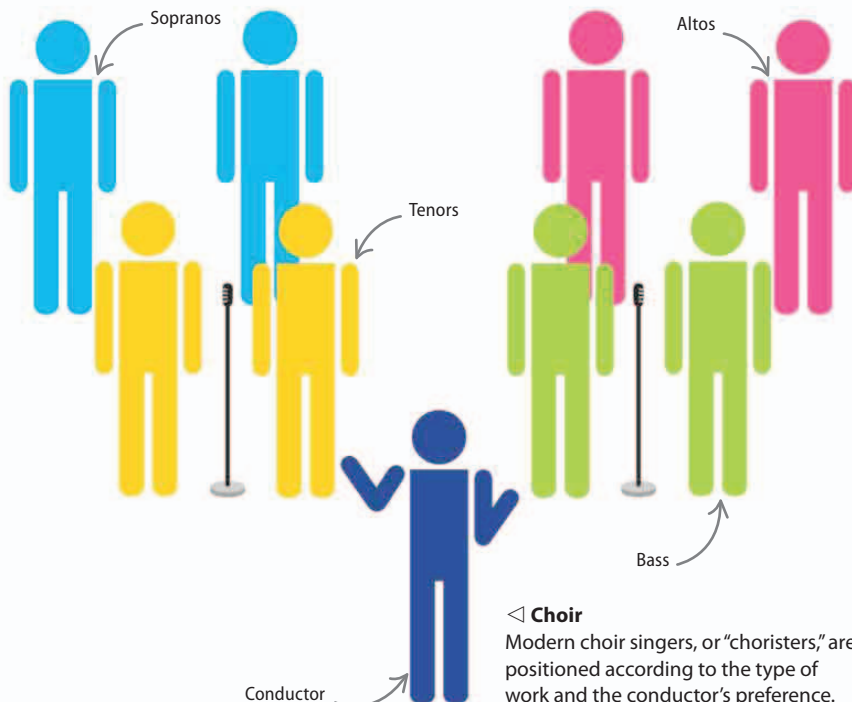
▷ Orchestra

Since the 18th century, composers have relished the infinite possibilities of writing for the orchestra, which offers an unparalleled range of colors, textures, and special effects.



Choirs

Church choirs are traditionally arranged in two separate groups—*Decani* (Dean's side) and *Cantoris* (Cantor's side)—on two sides of the chancel. Outside a church, choral music is also performed in halls by choirs or choruses grouped according to voice.



◁ Choir

Modern choir singers, or "choristers," are positioned according to the type of work and the conductor's preference.

REAL WORLD

Thomas Tallis (c.1505–1585)

One of the greatest composers of choral music, Tallis held musical posts in English churches and the Royal Court. The 40 individual voices in his 1570 motet, *Spem in alium* (Hope in Another), create a stunning effect as they reverberate around a performance space.

